



48–56 cm
19–22 in

GREY-WINGED TRUMPETER
Psophia crepitans
F: Psophiidae
Named for their loud calls, trumpeters are gregarious Amazonian ground birds that are weak fliers. This is a black-bodied species, which – like other trumpeters – has a “hunchback” appearance.



1–1.2 m
3½–4 ft

BROLGA
Grus rubicunda
F: Gruidae
This Australian crane has a bare red head and black dewlap (flap under the chin). It performs a spectacular prancing courtship display.



1–1.1 m
3¼–3½ ft

BLUE CRANE
Anthropoides paradiseus
F: Gruidae
The long wing plumes of this African crane resemble a tail. When not breeding, it is nomadic, frequenting lakeside, grassland, and farmland.



1.4–1.5 m
4½–5 ft

RED-CROWNED CRANE
Grus japonensis
F: Gruidae
Declining in numbers, this bird breeds in Siberia and overwinters in Korea and China. The heaviest of all cranes, like related species, it has a bare, red crown patch.

GREY CROWNED CRANE
Balearica regulorum
F: Gruidae
African crowned cranes are the only cranes that can grip branches, enabling them to roost in trees. This is the most southerly species.



1.1 m
3½ ft



1.1–1.2 m
3½–4 ft

SANDHILL CRANE
Grus canadensis
F: Gruidae
A N. American crane, this species also reaches westwards into Siberia. It migrates south in family groups, as far as Mexico.



1.1–1.2 m
3½–4 ft

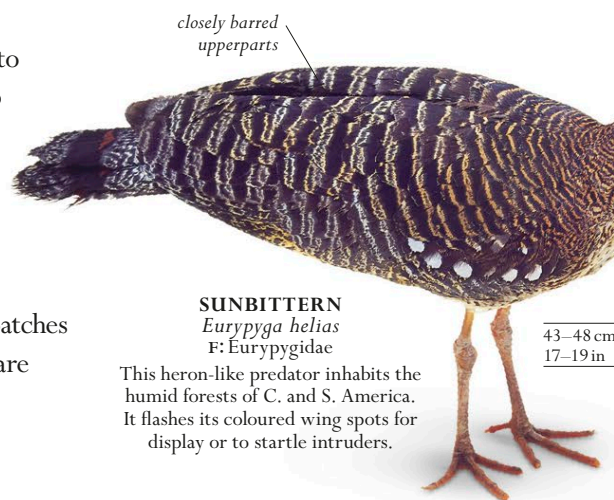
COMMON CRANE
Grus grus
F: Gruidae
Frequenting marsh, heathland, and tundra, this bird breeds in Eurasia and migrates to N. Africa and S. Asia, often in a V-formation.

KAGU AND SUNBITTERN

Recently separated from the cranes and rails, the tropical kagu and sunbittern are unique birds of damp forest, limited to very restricted geographical ranges.

A handful of species worldwide are difficult to place in a relationship with others: these two appear to be closely related, but look very different. Their position in the evolutionary tree is still controversial. The kagu reveals broad grey and white bands across its wings, when they are spread in courtship displays. The sunbittern likewise shows unexpected patches of colour on its upper wings and tail, which are fanned horizontally to create a single, broad pattern when it is displaying.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	AVES
ORDER	EURYPYGIFORMES
FAMILIES	2
SPECIES	2



closely barred upperparts

SUNBITTERN
Eurypyga helias
F: Eurypygidae
This heron-like predator inhabits the humid forests of C. and S. America. It flashes its coloured wing spots for display or to startle intruders.



55 cm
22 in

KAGU
Rhynochetos jubatus
F: Rhynochetidae
Confined to the forests of New Caledonia in the southwestern Pacific, the kagu lacks strong muscles necessary for flight. Instead, it uses its wings to glide and for display.